# **Neck Disability Mini -DBQ** (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

**Please mark your diagnosed condition. Check all that apply**:

- ☐ Mechanical cervical pain syndrome
- ☐ Cervical sprain/strain
- ☐ Cervical spondylosis (degenerative joint disease of cervical spine)
- ☐ Degenerative disc disease
- ☐ Foraminal
- ☐ Stenosis/central stenosis
- ☐ Intervertebral disc syndrome
- ☐ Radiculopathy
- ☐ Myelopathy
- ☐ Ankylosis of Cervical Spine (Neck)
- ☐ Ankylosing spondylitis of cervical spine (neck)
- ☐ Vertebral Fracture
- ☐ Others (specify):

**Please answer the following questions related to your disease:**

a) How long have you had this condition?

b) What caused the problem during you service (i.e. weight lifting, injury etc.)?

c) Do you experience flare-ups (worsening of condition and the features associated with it i.e. pain, stiffness etc.)?
*If yes, what do you think causes these flare-ups?*

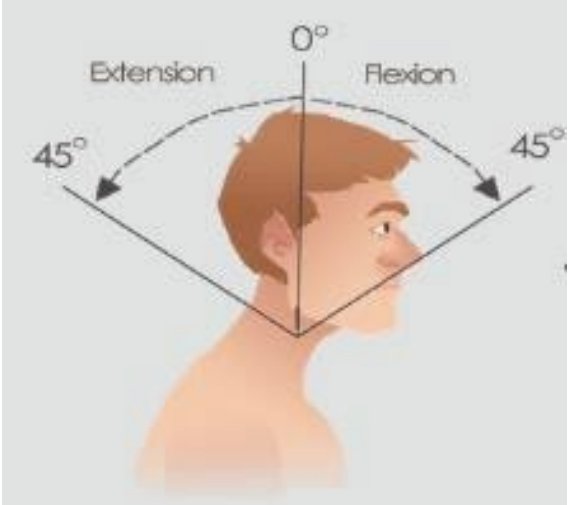
d) How do these flare-ups (worsening of conditions) affect your daily life and work (*if currently employed) ie. pain, disturbed movement, weakness, swelling etc.?*

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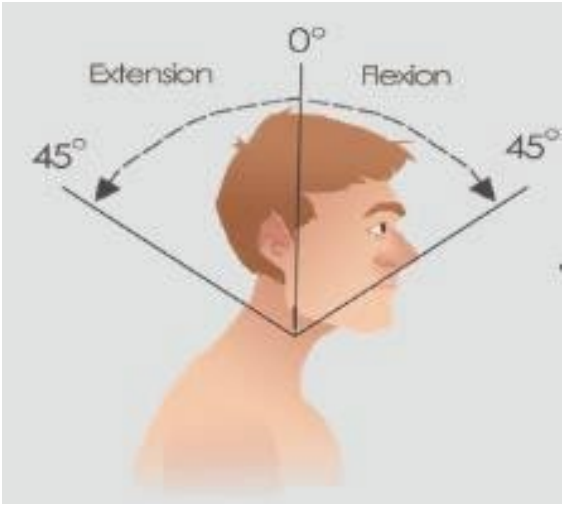
**What is your dominant hand?** ☐ Right ☐ Left ☐ Ambidextrous

**RANGE OF MOTION:** **THIS DETERMINES YOUR DISABILITY RATING**

| **Range of Motion for your Neck - FLEXION**<br>Begin by standing. Bend your chin to chest as shown in picture to the right |
|---|
| **Forward Flexion** |
| To which degree can you bend forward? (45 degrees is full range of motion). |
| **Flare-Ups: Think about when your Neck is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above!** |
| How far over in degrees can you bend forward during a FLARE UP? |

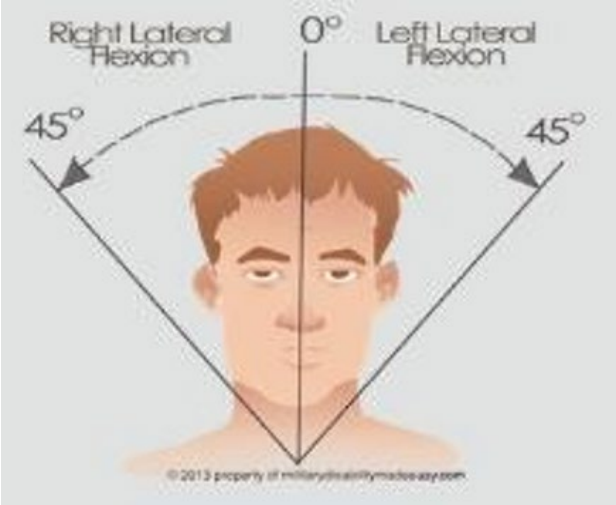



| **Range of Motion for your Neck - EXTENSION**<br>Begin by standing. Bend neck backwards as shown in picture to the right |
|---|
| **Backward Extension** |
| To which degree can you bend backward? (45 degrees is full range of motion). |
| **Flare-Ups: Think about when your Neck is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above!** |
| How far over in degrees can you bend forward during a FLARE UP? |

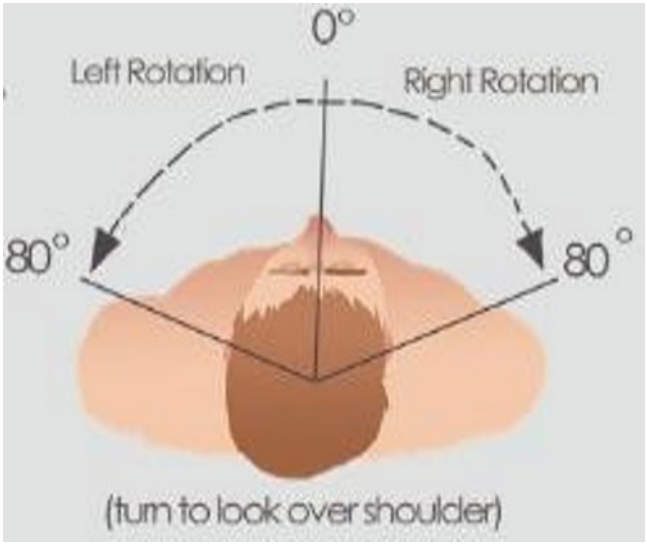


# **Neck Disability Mini -DBQ** (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

| **Range of Motion for your Neck – Right and Left Lateral FLEXION**<br>Begin by standing. Bend your neck to the left and right as shown in picture to the right | |
|---|---|
| **Right and Left Flexion** | |
| To which degree can you bend to both sides? (45 degrees is full range of motion). | |
| **Left** | **Right** |
| **Flare-Ups: Think about when your neck is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above!** | |
| How far over in degrees can you bend to both sides during a FLARE UP? | |
| **Left** | **Right** |




| **Range of Motion for your Back – Right and Left Lateral ROTATION**<br>Begin by standing. Twist your neck to look over your shoulder as shown in picture to right | |
|---|---|
| **Right and Left Rotation** | |
| To which degree can you bend to both sides? (80 degrees is full range of motion). | |
| **Left** | **Right** |
| **Flare-Ups: Think about when your Neck is HURTING. *This number should be LESS than the one above!*** | |
| How far over in degrees can you bend to both sides during a FLARE UP? | |
| **Left** | **Right** |



# **Neck Disability Mini -DBQ** (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

**Please check all the symptom(s) that apply to your condition:**

☐ Incoordination *(impaired ability to execute skilled movements smoothly*)

☐ Swelling *(tenderness) (If marked please specify if there is pain on touching the swelling)*

☐ Weakened Movement (feeling weakness in muscles) ☐ Pain on Movement

☐ Easily Fatigued ☐ Less movement than normal ☐ Atrophy of disuse (decreased muscle mass)

☐ Disturbance in movements ☐ Interferes with sitting ☐ Interferes with standing

**VERY IMPORTANT:**

**History of Neck Surgery – Provide type of surgery, indicate if VA did surgery or private doctor, and date:**

**RADICULOPATHY - Also known as NERVE ISSUES and/or RADIATING PAIN DOWN ARMS)**
**Symptoms of radiculopathy are very common with back disabilities, and you may be eligible for additional ratings**

***Common symptoms***:

*Sharp **pain** starting in the neck, extending to the arms. Sharp **pain** with sitting or coughing. **Numbness** or **weakness** in the arms. **Numbness** or **tingling** in the neck or arms.*

- ***Mild symptoms***: doesn't really interfere with activities of daily living (ADLs), only minor issues
- ***Moderate symptoms***: does affect ADLs; more constant and painful and/or weakened movement

**Do you ever experience ANY symptoms at ANY time of radiculopathy?**

☐ Yes, **MILD** symptoms ☐ Right Arm ☐ Left Arm ☐ Both Arms

☐ Yes, **MODERATE** symptoms ☐ Right Arm ☐ Left Arm ☐ Both Arms

☐ No, I do not have radiculopathy symptoms

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*Additional Information*

**CERTIFICATION - To the best of my knowledge, the information contained herein is accurate, complete and current. I understand that overstating the severity of my conditions on official Disability Benefits Questionnaires (DBQs) could result in loss of benefits and/or be consider fraudulent. I am conveying the severity of my symptoms to the best of my ability on this personal assessment form. No one has advised me to misrepresent my conditions or overstate the severity of my symptoms.**